

Executive Project Report: Corporate Payroll Overview Dashboard

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Tools Used: **Power BI Desktop, Microsoft Excel, DAX, Power Query**

Links: [GitHub](#)

1. Executive Summary

This project delivers a comprehensive analysis of corporate payroll distribution across multiple organizational divisions, industries, and department units for the 2024–2026 fiscal periods. Managing a total payroll spend of **\$578.44M** against a **\$600.00M** budget baseline, the organization maintained a favorable budget variance of **-3.59%**. A key finding includes an extreme monthly spend anomaly in February (**\$18.60M vs ~ 55M–\$56M monthly average**), alongside heavy expenditure concentration in three primary industries (*Internal Corporate Ops, Retail & E-Commerce, and Technology & SaaS*).

2. Project Objectives & Scope

Objective: Develop an interactive financial decision-making dashboard to give leadership clear visibility into payroll expenditure trends, variance against budget, tax deductions, and departmental cost distribution.

Scope: Analyze multi-year payroll records spanning **2024 through 2026**, covering 500+ customers/employees across 5 primary industry sectors and multiple specialized department units.

Core Business Metrics Tracked: Total Payroll, Budgeted Payroll, Payroll Variance %, Tax Deducted, YTD Payroll, and Overtime Pay Ratio.

3. Data Architecture & Schema

The data model is structured as a **Snowflake Schema** to ensure optimal data normalization, query performance, and relational integrity within Power BI.

Fact Table:

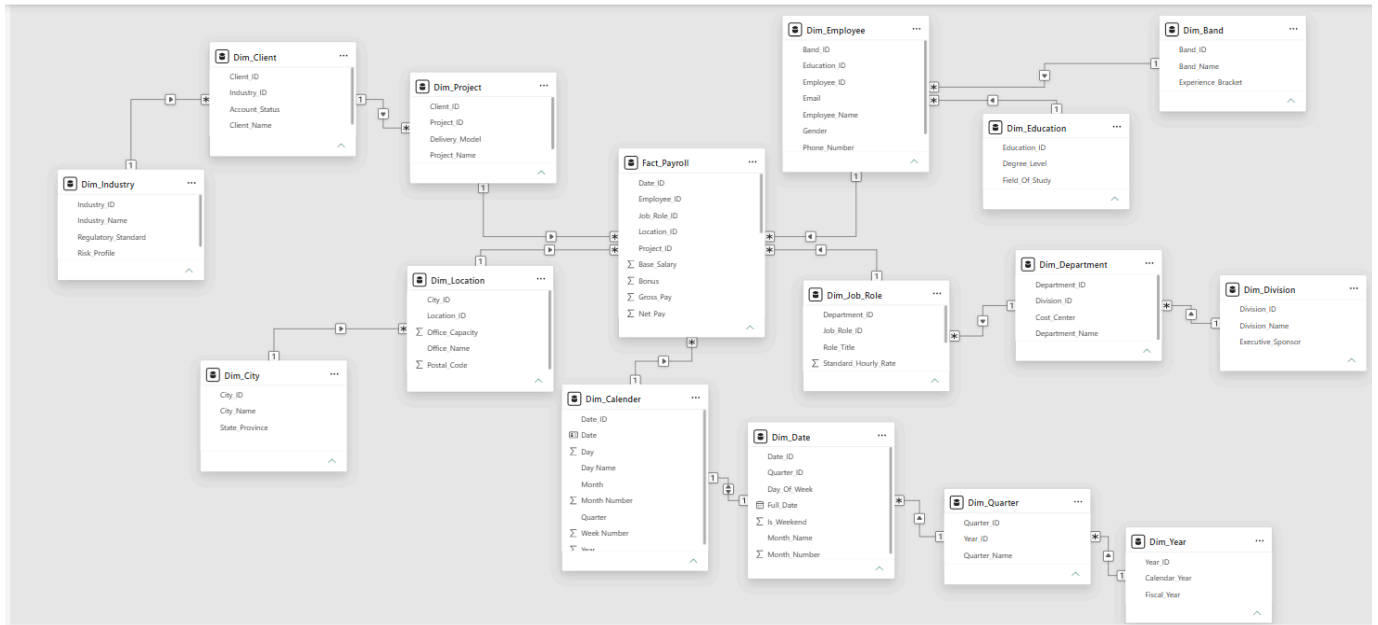
fact_payroll: Contains transactional measures including sales/payroll IDs, base amounts, taxes, discounts, overtime, and foreign key references.

Dimension Tables:

Dim_Band: Stores employee pay bands, job levels, or salary hierarchy classifications.

Dim_Calender: Acts as a custom date/calendar dimension for organizing fiscal periods.

Dim_City: Contains geographic city details where employees are based.



Dim_Client: Stores client details, company profiles, and account information.

Dim_Date: Primary date dimension used for time-intelligence calculations (dates).

Dim_Department: Contains internal functional units or department names.

Dim_Division: Stores higher-level corporate divisions comprising multiple departments.

Dim_Education: Captures employee educational qualifications or degree levels.

Dim_Employee: Stores individual staff records, IDs, names, and demographic data.

Dim_Industry: Classifies clients or operational sectors (e.g., SaaS, FinTech, Retail).

Dim_Job_Role: Details specific job titles, positions, and operational designations.

Dim_Location: Stores broader physical work locations, branches, or office sites.

Dim_Project: Contains client or internal project names, codes, and tracking details.

Dim_Quarter: Dedicated calendar lookup for fiscal and calendar quarter breakdowns.

Dim_Year: Higher-level date lookup table for year-over-year aggregation.

4. Key Metrics & DAX Calculations

Key measures were created using Data Analysis Expressions (DAX) to drive executive decision-making:

Total Payroll Spend:

Total Payroll = CALCULATE(SUM([Gross_Pay]))
(Result: \$578.44M)

Payroll Variance %:

Payroll Variance = (([Total Payroll] - [Budgeted Payroll]) / [Budgeted Payroll]) * 100
(Result: -3.59%)

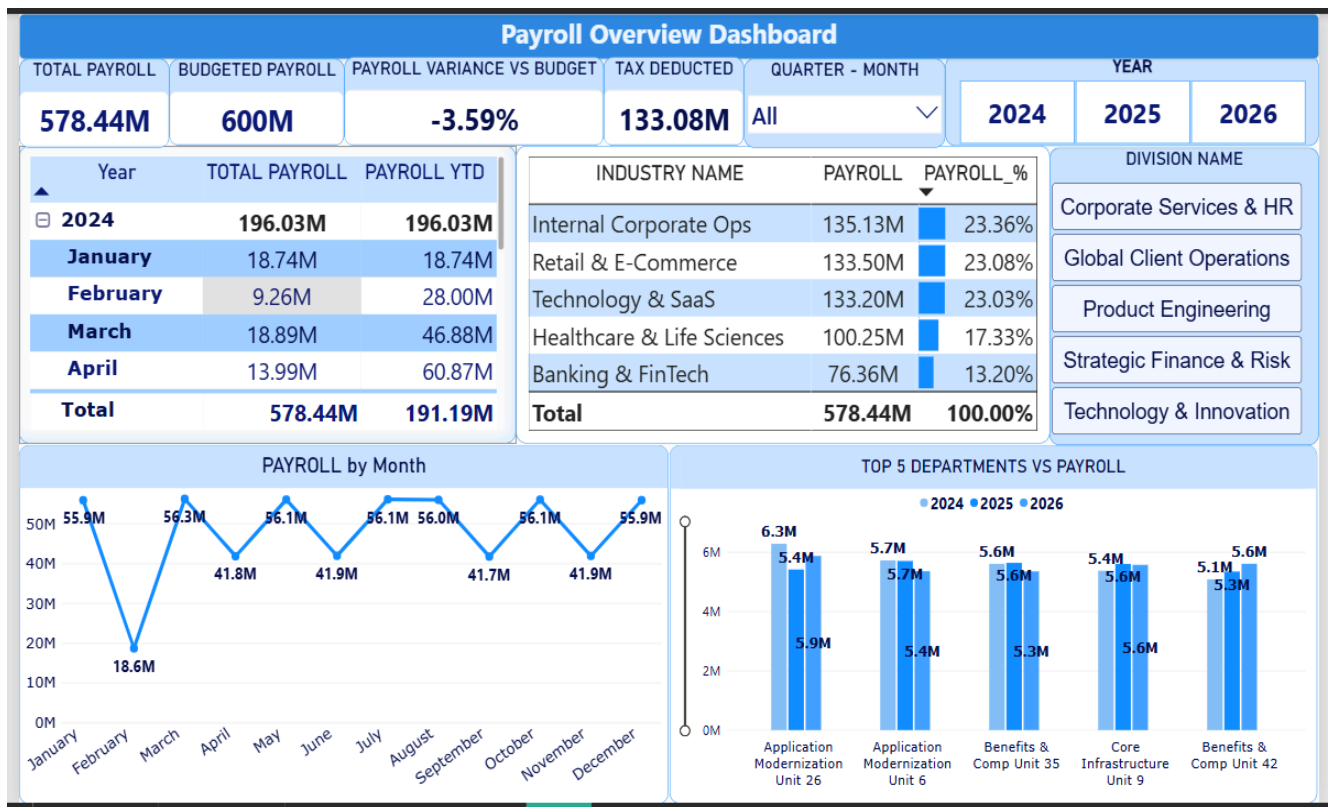
Payroll Year-To-Date (YTD):

PAYROLL_TOTALYTD = TOTALYTD([TOTAL_PAYROLL], Dim_Calender[Date])
(Result: 2026 - \$191.19M ; 2025 - \$191.22M ; 2024 - \$196.03M)

Overtime Pay Ratio:

OVERTIME_RATIO = DIVIDE([TOTAL_OVERTIME_PAY], SUM(Fact_Payroll[Base_Salary]))
TOTAL_OVERTIME_PAY = SUM(Fact_Payroll[Overtime_Pay])
(Result: 1.76% / \$9.17M)

5. Dashboard Layout & Visual Breakdown



The report interface is divided into four functional logical zones:

Top KPI Summary Ribbon: Highlights high-level executive cards (*Total Payroll, Budgeted Payroll, Payroll Variance vs Budget, Tax Deducted*) paired with global Year, Quarter, and Month slicers.

Monthly Trend Analysis (Line Chart): Tracks monthly payroll fluctuations across the year to expose seasonal dips and spikes.

Department & Industry Breakdown (Clustered Column Chart & Matrix): Displays the top 5 department units by spending across 2024, 2025, and 2026, alongside an industry percentage matrix.

Hierarchical Drill-Down Matrix: Provides granular month-by-month and year-by-year YTD tracking.

6. Core Analytical Insights

Under-Budget Execution (-3.59%): Total payroll arrived was **\$21.56M under the \$600.00M budget ceiling**, demonstrating strong cost control across all divisions.

February Outlier: Monthly payroll remains consistent at **~\$55.9M - \$56.3M** for 11 months of the year, but experiences a steep drop to **\$18.6M in February** (~67% reduction).

Heavy Industry Concentration: *Internal Corporate Ops* (\$135.13M / 23.36%), *Retail & E-Commerce* (\$133.50M / 23.08%), and *Technology & SaaS* (\$133.20M / 23.03%) collectively consume **over 69% of the total payroll budget**.

Technology Unit Demands: *Application Modernization Unit 26* and *Unit 6* represent the single largest departmental expenses across all three fiscal years (~\$5.7M - \$6.3M per unit annually).

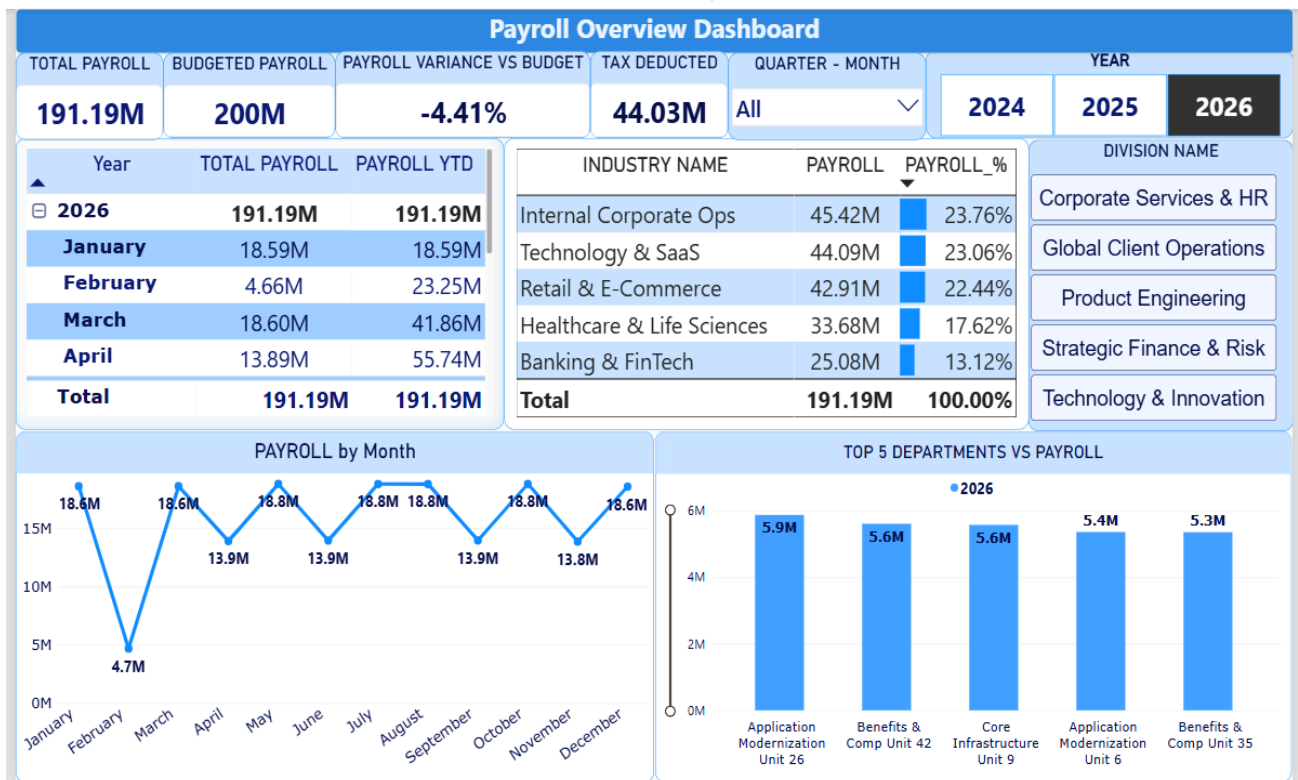
Controlled Overtime Expense: Overtime pay accounts for only **1.76% (\$9.17M)** of total payroll spend, proving that regular staffing hours are well-optimized.

7. Business Recommendations

Investigate February Accounting Processes: Conduct an operational audit to determine if February's \$18.6M low payout is caused by seasonal contractor cycles, delayed bonus accounting, or logging delays.

Reallocate Resource Allocations: With *Banking & FinTech* taking up the smallest payroll share (13.20% / \$76.36M), evaluate whether additional staffing is required to balance growth against higher-spend divisions.

Reinvest \$21.56M Variance Budget: Maintain the baseline \$600M budget allocation while re-channeling the \$21.56M favorable surplus into high-growth tech initiatives and specialized hiring.



8. Technical Tools & Stack

Data Processing & Prep: Microsoft Excel (Power Query, Data Cleaning, Normalization)

Data Modeling: Power BI (Snowflake Schema, Star Schema, Relationships, DAX Measures)

Visualization & UX: Power BI Desktop (Interactive KPI Cards, Matrix Visuals, Dynamic Formatting)